# 2025 nonfiction hotlist.

23 ambitious nonfiction projects with extraordinary creative potential, each looking for the support to move forward.




# welcome to the nonfiction hotlist

We believe creators and storytellers are the lifeblood of our industry and deserve more pathways to bring their visions to life.

This curated collection represents **23 ambitious projects** that have demonstrated extraordinary creative potential but need support to move forward.

OUR INVITATION

While funding and distribution remain universal needs for all these projects, we believe there are many ways to help reduce costs and build momentum.

Look through these projects with an eye for how you might contribute. Each page identifies specific needs, from production support to technical expertise to strategic connections.

# why this matters

The marketplace needs ambitious, unusual, and visionary nonfiction projects. When we collaborate as a community, we create new possibilities and counter the risk-aversion of traditional gatekeepers. Every contribution, whether financial investment or in-kind support, generates meaningful momentum, giving creators more leverage.

Supporting these projects strengthens not only their individual journeys but the broader health and vibrancy of our entire nonfiction ecosystem. The hundreds of other remarkable submissions we received confirm the wealth of untapped storytelling potential waiting for champions.

**23**

PROJECTS SELECTED FROM HUNDREDS OF SUBMISSIONS

SELECTED ON THEIR MERITS

- Originality
- Feasibility
- Compelling subjects
- Evocative storytelling

Some creators are first-time filmmakers; others are established voices who still face challenges securing support for ambitious work. What unites them is the exceptional quality of their vision.

HOW TO USE THIS LIST

**1**
**Reach out**
Contact projects directly whose vision inspires you.

**2**
**Give**
Support their 501(c)(3) fiscal sponsorships where available.

**3**
**Follow**
Follow their creative journeys across social platforms.

**4**
**Contribute**
Review each project's How to help section and offer the specific resources they need.

**This document is meant to be used. These projects are meant to be made. The future of exceptional nonfiction storytelling depends on our collective action.**

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# projects

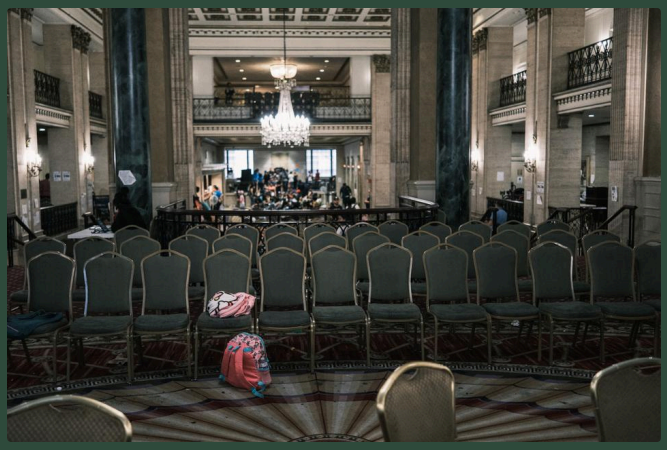




FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## The Animated Mind of Oliver Sacks

Newly uncovered recordings and immersive animation trace Oliver Sacks' early work with patients and the private conflicts behind it.



40 TO 60 MINUTES

## The Arrival Center

Inside the Roosevelt Hotel, New York's modern-day Ellis Island, as asylum seekers and the city workers who serve them face its closure.



FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## AUNTIES

Four Chinese immigrant dancers, average age 70, chase their dream of performing on the grand stage.




FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## A City in the Forest

A decentralized movement fights to stop Atlanta's police foundation from razing an urban forest to build "Cop City."

**World Premiere**, Sheffield DocFest 2026 +9 more

# projects





FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## Daddy

After her father comes out late in life, a filmmaker spends five years documenting her Southern family's search for acceptance.



FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## Earth to Michael

Before his astronaut father heads back to space, a son asks him to explore the distance between them.

**Official Selection**, Telluride Film Festival 2025 +1 more



FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## Erin's Law

A survivor's law protecting children has passed in 38 states. The film investigates who is blocking it in the other 12.



FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## Father Figures

A filmmaker turns to puppets to reach a father who opens up more to his ventriloquist dummies than to his family.

# projects





FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## God of Sight

A rebel surgeon from the mountains of Nepal defies a broken medical system to restore sight to millions.



FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## Good Kids

In Helena, Montana, a teenager's skate shop becomes a haven for friends facing their last year before adulthood.




FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## The Grind

A tech worker turned adult film performer confronts injury, debt, and the economics of selling sex online.



FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## Lift Off

Three teenagers from very different American communities compete in the world's largest student rocketry contest.

# projects





FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## Making the Line

Two queer Native Hawaiian master teachers lead their students into the world of competitive hula.

**World Premiere**, Hawai'i International Film Festival 2026




FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## Manhood

A Dallas businessman sets out to make penis enlargement as commonplace as Botox.

**World Premiere**, SXSW 2026 +2 more



FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## Movement

Behind the scenes with the choreographers who shape Super Bowl halftime shows, Broadway, and the Eras Tour.



SHORT DOCUMENTARY

## Screw Lucy

A divorced mother of three takes on her corrupt Florida sheriff and becomes a Pulitzer winner.

# projects





FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## State of Gambling

The lawyers who took down Big Tobacco build the first landmark case against online sports betting.




FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## Talked to Death

Talk radio star Alan Berg's on-air confrontations with neo-Nazis led to his murder by a white nationalist cult.



SHORT DOCUMENTARY

## Thank You for Listening

Country singer Joshua Ray Walker battles third-generation cancer while planning his return to the Grand Ole Opry.

**Official Selection**, Dallas International Film Festival 2026 +4 more



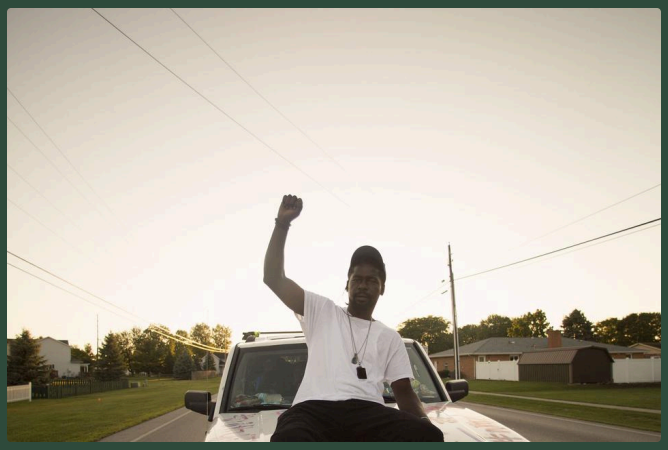
FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## Vestibule

A filmmaker chronicles her decade-long fight with a vulvovaginal disorder and a medical system that dismisses it.

# projects





FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## Walk With Me

A 768-mile protest march ends in a shooting, and competing accounts leave the victim facing charges.



FEATURE DOCUMENTARY

## Whale Like Me

Richard Wright's grandson spends ten years brokering encounters between whales and the people who hunt them.



PODCAST, 11 PARTS

## When We All Get to Heaven

How one of the first gay-positive churches faced the AIDS epidemic, told through 1,200 rescued recordings.

**Winner, Podcast & Radio**, Peabody Awards 2025 +4 more



01 / 23

# the animated mind of oliver sacks

*Newly uncovered recordings and immersive animation trace Oliver Sacks' early work with patients and the private conflicts behind it.*


**SUMMARY**

A newly uncovered trove of personal audio and video recordings, combined with immersive animation, traces Dr. Oliver Sacks' early work with patients alongside the private conflicts shaping his inner life, revealing how a brilliant, humane, yet flawed man sought to understand neurological disorder and communicate it through writing that blurred the line between patient and doctor.



**NEWS GRANT**

Supported by Jewish Story Partners. Jewish Story Partners


**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Dempsey Rice** Director/Producer

**Lori Cheatle** Producer

**Maeve O'Boyle** Editor

**Michael Hearst** Composer



| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | In post-production, aiming to finish by early 2026 |
| **CONTACT** | animatedmind@dempseyrice.com |

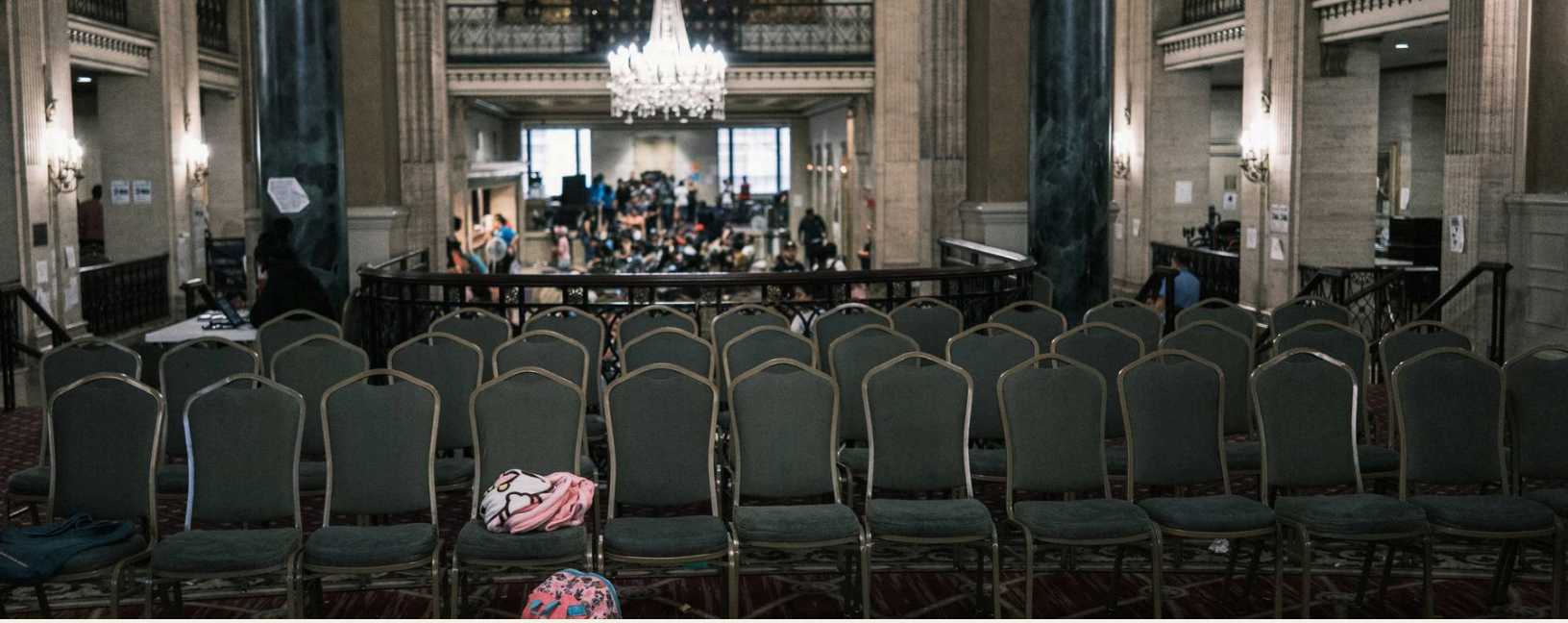
**HOW TO HELP**

+ Philanthropic donations and investment
+ Animation services
+ Archival research and clearance
+ Fair use legal services
+ Sound design, edit and mix
+ Online edit
+ Social media strategy
+ Impact producing

**LINKS**

Website | Donate | Instagram | Facebook

Deck and sizzle on request



02 / 23

# the arrival center

*Inside the Roosevelt Hotel, New York's modern-day Ellis Island, as asylum seekers and the city workers who serve them face its closure.*


**SUMMARY**

THE ARRIVAL CENTER is an immersive documentary filmed inside the epicenter of New York's migrant crisis. The Roosevelt Hotel in midtown Manhattan is a modern day Ellis Island, open 24/7 and staffed by hundreds of city workers. The operation manages intake, provides vital healthcare, and connects families to services. Hundreds of families also live at the hotel on a temporary basis. The film is a glimpse into the lives of these asylum-seekers and those of everyday New Yorkers who keep the place running.

Against a backdrop of growing risk for immigrants and sanctuary cities once the new administration comes to power, City Hall decides to close the Arrival Center and families seeking security face difficult choices.


| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | 40 to 60 minutes |
| **STATUS** | In production |
| **CONTACT** | thearrivalcenterfilm@gmail.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ Executive producers
+ Production company partners
+ Legal services
+ In-kind post-production support
+ Gear loan (Canon or Sony camera kit)

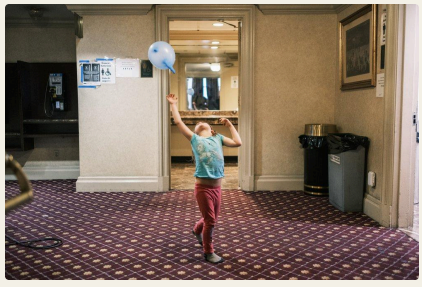
**CREATIVE TEAM**

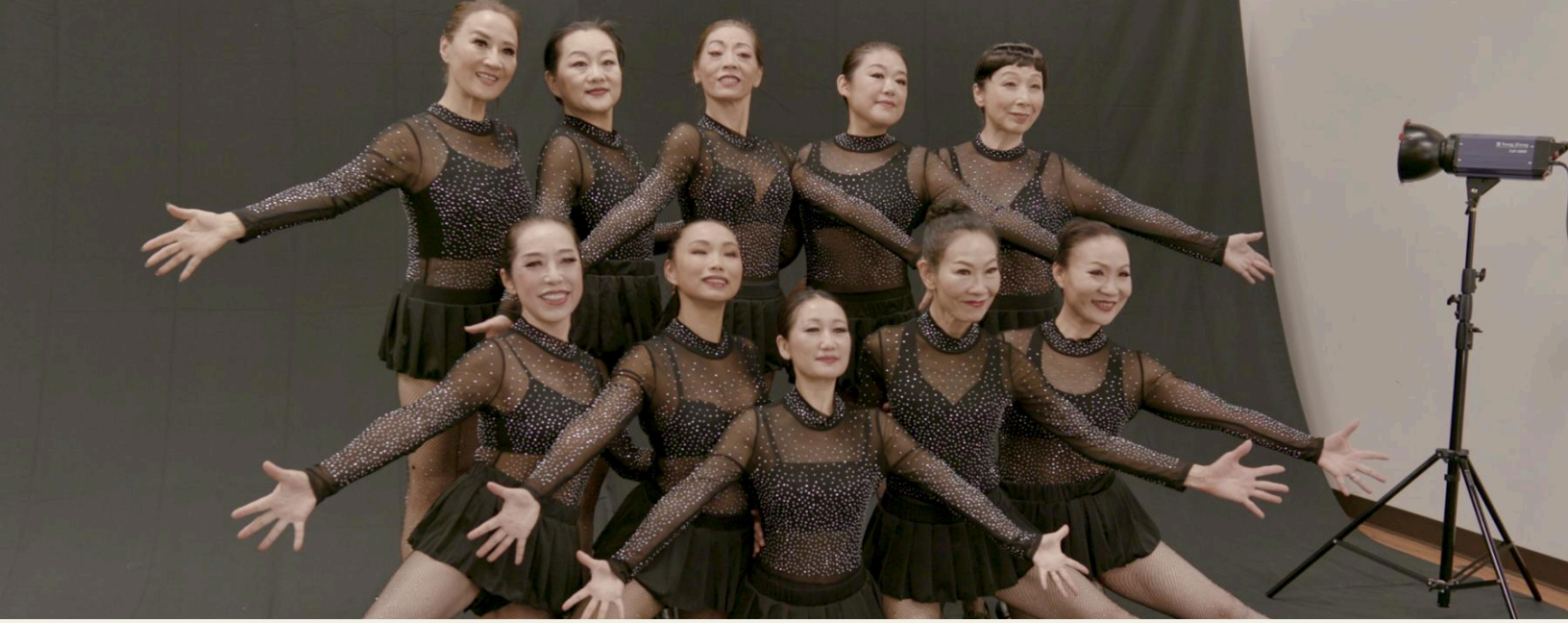
**Gregory Purpura** Co-Director/Producer

**Nicole Salazar** Co-Director/Producer

**Stephen Yang** Producer







03 / 23

# aunties

*Four Chinese immigrant dancers, average age 70, chase their dream of performing on the grand stage.*

**SUMMARY**

AUNTIES is a heartwarming and inspirational tale that follows mainly 4 Chinese immigrants, with an average age of 70, as they pursue their dream of performing on the grand stage. Led by their dedicated dance coach Yaya, these amateur dancers form a tight-knit community bound by their passion for dance. Through their journey, the film explores themes of aging, mortality, the immigrant experience, and the transformative power of dance in bringing people together. At its core, the story illustrates that the journey of self-discovery knows no age limits, echoing the timeless essence of coming-of-age narratives.

**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Haohao Yan** Director
**Guo Guo** Producer
**Diane Quon** Consulting Producer






| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | Post-production |
| **CONTACT** | auntyuntitledfilm@gmail.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ Editing consultation
+ Color grading
+ Music composition
+ Royalty-free music from artists
+ Sound design and mix
+ Social media management
+ Impact partners
+ Dance community support
+ Brand sponsorship
+ Sales and distribution

**LINKS**

Pitch deck | Sizzle | Website



04 / 23

# a city in the forest

*A decentralized movement fights to stop Atlanta's police foundation from razing an urban forest to build "Cop City."*

WORLD PREMIERE
**Sheffield DocFest**
2026

SPECIAL MENTION, INTERNATIONAL FIRST FEATURE
**Sheffield DocFest**
2026

BEST DOCUMENTARY FEATURE
**Nashville Film Festival**
2026

SPECIAL MENTION, HUMAN RIGHTS DOX
**DokuFest**
2026

JURY SPECIAL MENTION
**DMZ Docs**
2026

NEW YORK PREMIERE
**DOC NYC**
2026

OFFICIAL SELECTION
**New/Next Film Festival**
2026

OFFICIAL SELECTION
**Hot Springs Documentary Film Festival**
2026

OFFICIAL SELECTION
**Chicago International Film Festival**
2026

OFFICIAL SELECTION
**New Orleans Film Festival**
2026


## SUMMARY

When a private police foundation in Atlanta tries to raze an urban forest to build the country's largest police training facility, a diverse, decentralized, and intersectional movement defends the forest from what they call "Cop City." A CITY IN THE FOREST paints a collective portrait of the country's most urgent social justice story, where a web of activists fight back against environmental racism, political corruption, police violence, and the criminalization of dissent.


## NEWS

**NOV 2026** New York premiere at DOC NYC (November 11 to 19) in the Big Blue section. BroadwayWorld

**AUG 2026** Screened at DokuFest in Prizren, Kosovo, in the Human Rights Dox competition. DokuFest

**2026** Official selection at New/Next, the Hot Springs Documentary Film Festival, the Chicago International Film Festival and the New Orleans Film Festival. The Film Collaborative

## CREATIVE TEAM

**Lev Omelchenko** Director
**Nolan Huber-Rhoades** Director
**Ike Rofé** Producer
**Emily Yue** Editor

| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | Completed (99 min). On the festival circuit; sales by CAA, festival distribution by The Film Collaborative |
| **CONTACT** | acityintheforestfilm@gmail.com |

## HOW TO HELP

+ Finishing funds from like-minded grantors and investors
+ National and international outreach partners for the impact campaign
+ Sound designer with an ear for nature
+ In-kind finishing services
+ Follow on Instagram @acityintheforest

## LINKS

Donate | Instagram | Website

Deck and sizzle on request



05 / 23

# daddy

*After her father comes out late in life, a filmmaker spends five years documenting her Southern family's search for acceptance.*


**SUMMARY**

Facing her father's late-in-life coming out and her mother's broken heart, a filmmaker embarks on a poignant journey documenting over five years, her family's struggle with identity, grief, and acceptance in the American South. As the years pass, the film becomes an unexpected exploration of intergenerational queerness, revealing a universal story of family, forgiveness, and the enduring search for belonging.

DADDY is one family's coming-of-age story that began as an old man's coming-out story. It's about the unknowability of the people we love most, and the desire to try anyway.


**NEWS**

**2023** Hannah Myers was named a BAVC MediaMaker Fellow with DADDY. BAVC Media

**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Hannah Myers** Director
**Jessica Epstein** Producer
**Igor Myakotin** Consulting Producer
**Nevo Shinaar** Consulting Producer
**Keith Wilson** Consulting Producer
**Emily Simoness** Executive Producer
**Mahdokt Mamadoubadi** Editor

| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | Rough cut |
| **CONTACT** | daddydocumentaryfilm@gmail.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ Funding (grants and equity) for post-production
+ In-kind support for finishing (color, mix, graphics), social media, and web development
+ PR advice and strategy
+ Consultation on festival and distribution strategy
+ Connections to nonprofit community partners
+ Sign up for the newsletter at daddydocumentaryfilm.com

**LINKS**

Donate | Website

Deck and sizzle on request



06 / 23

# earth to michael

*Before his astronaut father heads back to space, a son asks him to explore the distance between them.*

OFFICIAL SELECTION
**Telluride Film Festival**
2025

EAST COAST PREMIERE
**DC/DOX**
2026

## SUMMARY


Before a Commander leaves Earth to usher in a new era of spaceflight, his son asks him to explore the unresolved space between them.

Michael last went to space when Nico was six. During his time in orbit, the family broke apart. Although Michael returned to Earth, he never came home. Now he's headed back to space, 15 years later. Can Nico bridge the distance before he leaves?

Equal parts interstellar and intimate, this coming-of-age story confronts two men of different generations and sexualities, asking us what sacrifices we'll make for our loved ones to achieve their dreams.


## NEWS

**JUN 2026** East Coast premiere at DC/DOX in Washington, DC. DC/DOX

**AUG 2025** Premiered at the Telluride Film Festival in the Backlot program. AwardsDaily

## CREATIVE TEAM

**Nico Lopez-Alegria** Director
**Zach Zuckerman** Director
**Steffie van Rhee** Producer
**Dustin Nakao-Haider** Producer

| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | Completed (91 min). Premiered at Telluride 2025; on the festival circuit |
| **CONTACT** | south4thstudios@gmail.com |

## HOW TO HELP

+ In-kind color and sound (New York based ideal)
+ Connections to financiers or brands
+ Film festival strategist
+ Social media strategist or publicist
+ Archival digitizing services
+ Other ideas welcome

## LINKS

Donate | Instagram

Deck and sizzle on request



07 / 23

# erin's law

*A survivor's law protecting children has passed in 38 states. The film investigates who is blocking it in the other 12.*

## SUMMARY

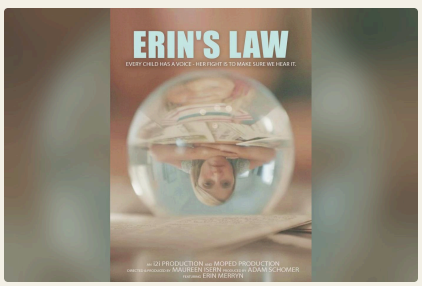
The true David vs Goliath story of Erin Merryn, as featured on Oprah and Katie Couric, who turned her experience of childhood sexual abuse into a mission that gives a voice to millions of children. Having passed Erin's Law in 38 states, we investigate the blocking of the law in the remaining 12, revealing the uncalculated costs of child sexual abuse to individuals and society, and the negligence of legislators failing to protect America's children. Erin's heroic story is an uplifting reminder of the power of determination and hope, that the truth can no longer be silenced.

## CREATIVE TEAM

**Maureen Isern** Director/Producer

**Adam Schomer** EP/Producer

**i2i Prod and Moped Prod** Production companies




| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | Development and early production |
| **CONTACT** | erinslawfilm@gmail.com |

## HOW TO HELP

+ Investors
+ Streamer and network connections
+ Referrals to female-driven production companies
+ Production crew
+ Motion graphics and animation
+ Social media manager
+ Travel sponsors (airfare, hotel, vehicle)

## LINKS

Website | Sizzle | Instagram | Donate



08 / 23

# father figures

*A filmmaker turns to puppets to reach a father who opens up more to his ventriloquist dummies than to his family.*

**SUMMARY**

A newly retired theater director, Bruce, begins creating internet videos featuring intimate conversations with his growing collection of ventriloquist dummies. Jealous of the fact that Bruce is far more open with his dummies than his own family, his daughter Emma embarks on a process of collaborative filmmaking, using puppets. FATHER FIGURES tells the story of Emma's attempt to repair her fraught relationship with her dad by exploring the psychological depths and possibilities of his strange new hobby.

**NEWS**

| | |
|---|---|
| MAR 2026 | Named a 2026 Sundance Institute Sandbox Fund grantee in the production category. Sundance Institute |
| 2024 | Emma D. Miller was a Jewish Film Institute Filmmaker in Residence with Father Figures. Jewish Film Institute |
| GRANT | Supported by Jewish Story Partners. Jewish Story Partners |

**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Emma D. Miller** Director/Producer
**Florrie Priest** Producer
**Colby Day** Producer
**Katrina Taylor** Editor
**Ora DeKornfeld** DP

| | |
|---|---|
| FORMAT | Feature documentary |
| STATUS | Post-production |
| CONTACT | emma@marconamedia.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ Connections to funders, both philanthropic and equity
+ In-kind support for LA-based color and sound mix
+ In-kind support for social media strategy and impact producing

**LINKS**

Donate | Instagram

Deck and sizzle on request



09 / 23

# god of sight

*A rebel surgeon from the mountains of Nepal defies a broken medical system to restore sight to millions.*

**SUMMARY**

GOD OF SIGHT is a thrilling, high-stakes adventure that follows Dr. Sanduk Ruit, a rebel surgeon from the mountains of Nepal, as he defies the impossible to restore sight to millions. Alongside his brash Australian mentor, Fred Hollows, and the adrenaline-fueled mountaineer-turned-doctor Geoff Tabin, they take on treacherous landscapes, smuggle lenses past authorities, and challenge a broken medical system, risking everything to prove that world-class healthcare belongs to everyone. GOD OF SIGHT is a gripping testament to courage, defiance, and the relentless pursuit of a dream.

**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Cole Sax** Director

**Phil Hessler** Producer



| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | In production; seeking resources to cut the first 30 minutes and take the film to market |
| **CONTACT** | cole@thinkless.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ In-kind post-production support to edit the first 30 minutes as a proof of concept for distributors
+ Introductions to brand sponsors and distributors
+ Post-production partners for editing and story producing

**LINKS**

Sizzle | Pitch deck



10 / 23

# good kids

*In Helena, Montana, a teenager's skate shop becomes a haven for friends facing their last year before adulthood.*

**SUMMARY**

GOOD KIDS is a coming-of-age documentary set in Helena, Montana that follows the mayhem of a group of high schoolers enjoying their final year together as adulthood fast approaches. Jake, an eighteen-year-old shifty entrepreneur, opens up a brick-and-mortar skateshop called Creep Skate Co., which quickly becomes a haven as the kids face religious pressure, broken homes, and fast-approaching adulthood.

**NEWS**

**JUL 2025** Selected for Catapult Film Fund's tenth Rough Cut Retreat cohort. Catapult Film Fund

**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Daniel Yonathan** Director

**Ike Rofé** Producer

**McCray Sutherlin** Producer



| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | Rough cut |
| **CONTACT** | ike@muddywater.co |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ Skateboarders and brands who can help fund the impact campaign and release
+ A sound designer inspired by Pink Floyd's The Wall
+ An experienced editor who loves Paul Thomas Anderson, for fresh-eyed feedback
+ A musician ready to try their hand at composing

**LINKS**

Sizzle




11 / 23

# the grind

*A tech worker turned adult film performer confronts injury, debt, and the economics of selling sex online.*

**SUMMARY**

Leo Vice is a tech worker turned sex worker who's living his dreams as a male pornstar. But faced with the realities of injury, debt, and the punishing economics of selling sex in the digital age, can he survive the grind? THE GRIND brings you into the industry that shapes modern sexuality, through the eyes of workers who offer their bodies in service of the infinite scroll. Leo's escape from office life and initiation into the porn industry challenge our definitions of sex, love, race, and work, while his aspirations are nothing less than the American dream writ large.

**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Dan Chen** Director/Producer

**Eric Cook** Producer

**Gregory Kerrick** Cinematographer/Producer



| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | In production. Developed in the Documentary Development Initiative by The Gotham Film Institute and HBO Documentary Films |
| **CONTACT** | thedchen@gmail.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ Support to continue filming with cinema cameras and a dedicated sound mixer
+ Producers and production companies
+ Music composition
+ Brand partnerships
+ Camera rental deals, particularly extreme slow-motion cameras
+ Community manager

**LINKS**

Sizzle | Pitch deck




12 / 23

# lift off

*Three teenagers from very different American communities compete in the world's largest student rocketry contest.*

**SUMMARY**

LIFT OFF immerses viewers in the lives of three teenagers from vastly different American communities as they chase dreams fueled by science, hope, and hard-won opportunity. Through longitudinal vérité storytelling, the film explores how participation in the world's largest student model rocketry competition, and the mentorship, resources, and belonging that come with it, can shape not just what young people build, but who they become in a divided and unequal America.

**CREATIVE TEAM**

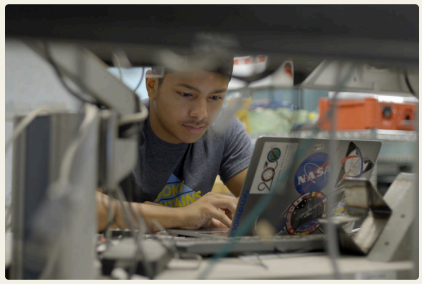
**Michael Crommett** Director/Producer/Cinematographer

**Julie Ann Crommett** EP

**Alejandra Vasquez** Producer

**Chai Vasarhelyi, Jimmy Chin, Anna Barnes** EPs



| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | Post-production |
| **CONTACT** | info@collectivemoxie.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ Co-production opportunities
+ Prominent STEM and education advocates
+ Connections to like-minded STEM nonprofits and advocacy organizations
+ Assistant editors with vérité experience
+ Brand partnerships
+ Post-production support: colorists, sound mix



13 / 23

# making the line

*Two queer Native Hawaiian master teachers lead their students into the world of competitive hula.*

WORLD PREMIERE
**Hawai'i International Film Festival**
2026

**SUMMARY**

MAKING THE LINE is a character-driven feature documentary that delves into the captivating world of competitive Hula. At its core, the film poignantly explores tradition, resilience, and identity.

The film follows two queer Kanaka Maoli (Native Hawaiian) Kumu Hula (master teachers of Hula), partners in both life and leadership, and their hāumāna (students), a diverse group of Native Hawaiian athletes. Together, their stories reveal the camaraderie, sisterhood, and brotherhood forged through competition. Audiences will find themselves rooting not just for a win, but for the preservation of a culture and the future of those who carry it forward.

**NEWS**

**OCT 2026** World premiere at the Hawaïi International Film Festival on October 22 at Consolidated Theatres Kāhala. The team is raising $80,000 for final post-production. Hawaii News Now

**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Zilla Barbosa** Director/Producer
**Sam Widdoes** Producer/Legal
**Ryan Simon** Producer

| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | World premiere at the Hawaïi International Film Festival, October 22, 2026. Raising $80,000 for final post-production |
| **CONTACT** | stephanie.barbosa@thevaultprod.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ Immediate funding and production support (Hawaii-based, Native Hawaiian, AAPI, and Indigenous preferred)
+ Post-production: lead editor, color, sound
+ Innovative distribution experts
+ Brand partnerships
+ Social media strategist
+ Audience engagement expert

**LINKS**

Instagram | Website | Donate

Deck and sizzle on request



14 / 23

# manhood

*A Dallas businessman sets out to make penis enlargement as commonplace as Botox.*

WORLD PREMIERE **SXSW** 2026 · OFFICIAL SELECTION **Sheffield DocFest** 2026 · NEW YORK PREMIERE **DOC NYC Selects** 2026

## SUMMARY

MANHOOD follows Dallas businessman Bill Moore as he sets out to make penis enlargement as commonplace as Botox. Along the way, a porn star and a father of five put their bodies, and their insecurities, on the line. Filmed over two years, MANHOOD explores shame, sex, and the fragile myths of American masculinity, with dark humor and unexpected empathy.

Production companies: World of Wonder, Madhouse Films, Outerboro Films.

## NEWS

**OCT 2026** Theatrical release opens in Los Angeles on October 28 and New York on October 30, followed by digital release on November 17. World of Wonder holds US streaming rights and the BBC has UK broadcast and iPlayer rights. The Movie Blog

**JUL 2026** New York premiere at IFC Center as part of DOC NYC Selects: Summer 2026, with a conversation with director Daniel Lombroso. DOC NYC

**JUN 2026** Official selection at Sheffield DocFest. The Film Collaborative

## CREATIVE TEAM

**Daniel Lombroso** Director
**Penny Lane** EP
**Gabriel Sedgwick** EP
**Marcus Gershenberg** EP
**Sheila Nevins** EP
**Randy Barbato** EP
**Fenton Bailey** EP
**Kerry Mack** Producer
**Rebecca Shaid** Producer
**David Zucker** Editor

| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | Completed (91 min). In theaters from October 28, 2026, digital from November 17. US streaming on World of Wonder; UK on the BBC |
| **CONTACT** | rebecca@outerboro.tv |

## HOW TO HELP

+ AI deepfake artist
+ PR
+ Social media strategy
+ Graphic designer
+ Impact producer
+ Distribution consultant

## LINKS

Instagram · Donate

Deck and sizzle on request



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# movement

*Behind the scenes with the choreographers who shape Super Bowl halftime shows, Broadway, and the Eras Tour.*


**SUMMARY**

MOVEMENT invites us behind the scenes of the world's most visionary choreographers. Inspired by "20 Feet from Stardom," a film that celebrated often-overlooked backup singers in music, MOVEMENT looks at the challenges and triumphs that shape a career in dance and showcases the evolution of dance as a form of cultural storytelling. From iconic live performances like the Super Bowl halftime show to viral music videos, from Broadway to the silver screen, choreographers Sienna Lalau (BTS, J-Lo), Mandy Moore ("La La Land," Taylor Swift "Eras Tour") and others have left indelible marks on the dance world. MOVEMENT examines the emotional, cultural, and personal layers behind dance's power to connect people worldwide.


**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Zac Manuel** Director

**Diane Quon** Producer

**Caryn Capotosto** Producer

**Sam Sutherland** Producer

| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | In development |
| **CONTACT** | dianemquon@gmail.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ Executive producers, studio or distribution partners
+ Connections to brand support: fashion, music, dance
+ Casting support for additional choreographers and dancers
+ Development funding for a pitch reel shoot and master interviews
+ In-kind services for a demo shoot
+ Dance studio for a teaser shoot
+ In-kind post services for the demo

**LINKS**

Pitch deck | Instagram



16 / 23

# screw lucy

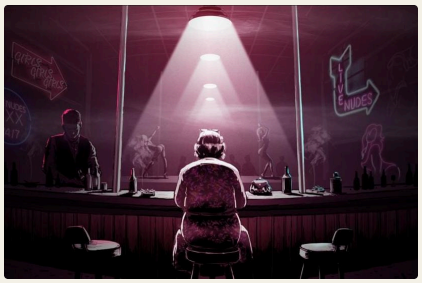
*A divorced mother of three takes on her corrupt Florida sheriff and becomes a Pulitzer winner.*


**SUMMARY**

As corruption grows in 1980s Florida, journalist Lucy Morgan investigates her local Pasco County sheriff with her own brand of justice. A divorced mother of three who dropped out of college but cared deeply about her Southern community, she ended up becoming one of the first women to win the Pulitzer Prize for investigative reporting.


**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Mary Pilon** Director/EP
**Dan Erdman** EP
**Seth Porges** EP
**Blake Gingerich** Editor
**Kate Simko** Composer





| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Short documentary |
| **STATUS** | Rough cut |
| **CONTACT** | marypilon@gmail.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ Production partner for the scripted rights and pitch
+ Budget for archival licensing
+ Post-production support including audio, color, and sound design
+ Legal support
+ Royalty-free music and composition
+ Brand partnerships

**LINKS**

Pitch deck | Sizzle | Instagram



17 / 23

# state of gambling

*The lawyers who took down Big Tobacco build the first landmark case against online sports betting.*

**SUMMARY**

The biggest game in sports isn't on a court. It's in court. STATE OF GAMBLING exposes the dark underbelly of America's booming online sports betting industry.

Follow two Boston lawyers, the same men who took down big tobacco decades earlier, as they build the first landmark case against sports gambling corporations, while the lobbyists try to stop them, and a young addict's rollercoaster journey is caught in the middle of it all.

For the past 18 months, the team has been attending Gambling Anonymous meetings, working with two Pulitzer Prize-winning writers from the New York Times covering the topic, and building strong connections with central characters.

**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Kyle Thrash** Director/Producer

**Austin Sokol** Producer

**Zack Bernstein** Producer

| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | Pre-production |
| **CONTACT** | austin@toothhurtymedia.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

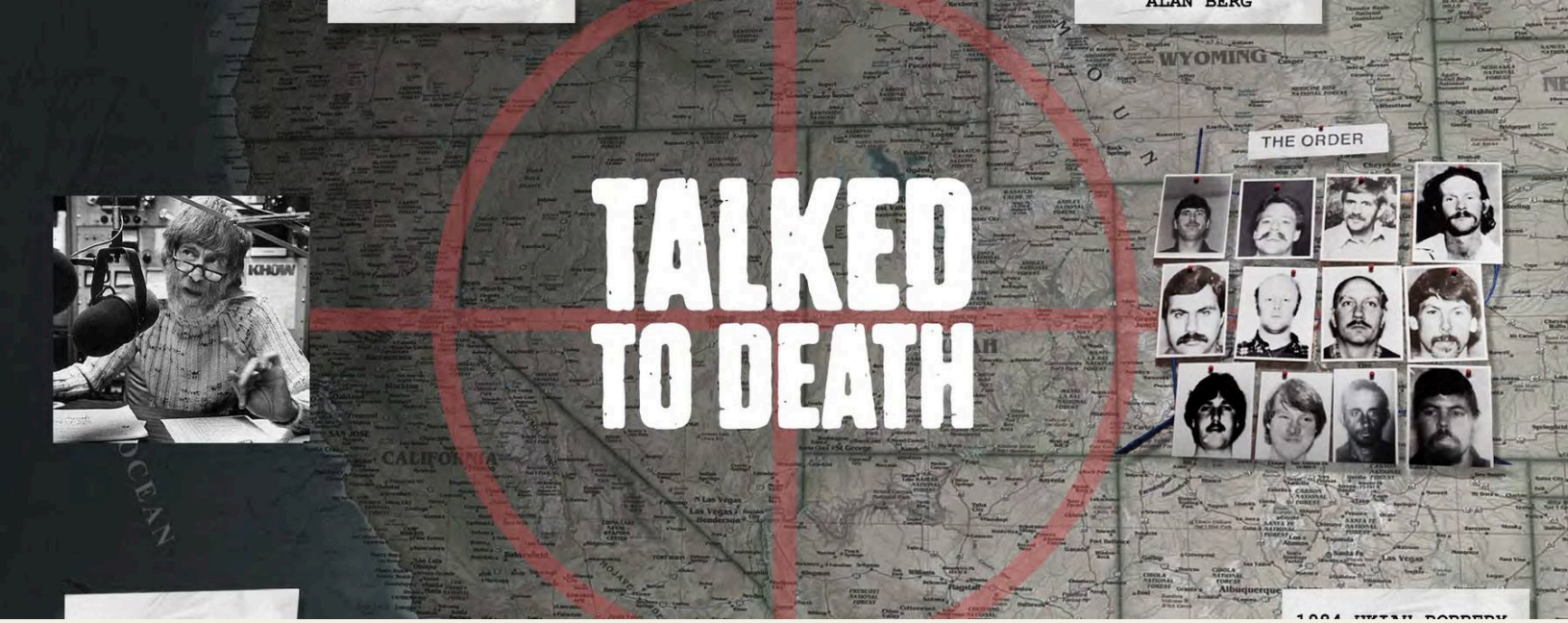
+ Access to elected officials in the House and Senate
+ Sports stars and league officials
+ Lobbyists
+ Leadership at online gambling companies

**LINKS**

Deck and sizzle on request










# talked to death

*Talk radio star Alan Berg's on-air confrontations with neo-Nazis led to his murder by a white nationalist cult.*

**SUMMARY**

Crazy, charismatic, and provocative, Alan Berg was a talk-radio star whose on-air confrontations with Neo-Nazis would lead to his murder by a cult of white nationalists known as The Order. Three decades later, The Order continues to inspire deadly violence in the name of white nationalism, while Berg's profound legacy has become a clarion call in our fight against prejudice and hate. The singular Marc Maron narrates and executive produces.

Originally pitched as a multi-episodic series, TALKED TO DEATH has been re-conceived as a feature documentary, for more flexibility to engage with independent financiers and producers who recognize the relevance of this timely story in the context of our current political climate.

**NEWS GRANT**

Supported by Jewish Story Partners. Jewish Story Partners

**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Josh Zeman** Director/EP
**Allyson Luchak** EP
**Zachary Mortensen** EP
**Joel Zimmer** EP
**Marc Maron** Narrator/EP

| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | Fully developed and ready for pre-production |
| **CONTACT** | josh.zeman@gmail.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ Independent financiers
+ Producers who recognize the story's relevance in the current political climate

**LINKS**

Pitch deck

Sizzle on request



19 / 23

# thank you for listening

*Country singer Joshua Ray Walker battles third-generation cancer while planning his return to the Grand Ole Opry.*

OFFICIAL SELECTION
**Dallas International Film Festival**
2026

OFFICIAL SELECTION
**Raindance Film Festival**

AUDIENCE AWARD, SHORT FILM
**Waco Independent Film Festival**

BEST TEXAS SHORT FILM
**Waco Independent Film Festival**

OFFICIAL SELECTION
**Yahoo x Nonfiction Hotlist Film Festival**
2026

## SUMMARY

THANK YOU FOR LISTENING chronicles Joshua Ray Walker's journey in creating East Dallas country music while battling third-generation cancer and planning his return to the Grand Ole Opry, the mecca of country music. Drawing inspiration from the spirit of the Lone Star State, the enchanting surrealism of films like Beasts of the Southern Wild, and a touch of Dolly Parton flair, this film weaves together personal, creative, and cellular elements in a visually captivating exploration of hope and healing.

## NEWS

**AUG 2026** Screened at the first Yahoo x Nonfiction Hotlist Film Festival at the American Dream center in East Rutherford, New Jersey, with Joshua Ray Walker performing. Yahoo

**AUG 2026** Streaming exclusively on Yahoo from August 19, presented by Texas Monthly. Selected as one of 20 films from nearly 1,000 submissions for the Yahoo x Nonfiction Hotlist slate. Texas Monthly

**2026** Debuted at the Dallas International Film Festival, screened at Raindance in London, won the Audience Award for short film and Best Texas Short Film at the Waco Independent Film Festival, and completed a limited theatrical run in Los Angeles. Texas Monthly

## CREATIVE TEAM

**Gene Gallerano** Director
**Bob Ray** Director
**Christina Bennett Lind** Editor
**Cyrus Stowe** Editor

| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Short documentary |
| **STATUS** | Completed. Streaming on Yahoo; presented by Texas Monthly |
| **CONTACT** | reachgenegallerano@gmail.com |

## HOW TO HELP

+ Music-obsessed EP or production company
+ Post-production editor, ideally pro bono or at a minimal rate (the score will be composed by the subject)
+ Social media for community building
+ Help creating a live screening tour
+ Brand partnerships
+ Distribution consultation

## LINKS

Trailer | Sizzle | Instagram

Deck on request



20 / 23

# vestibule

*A filmmaker chronicles her decade-long fight with a vulvovaginal disorder and a medical system that dismisses it.*

**SUMMARY**

VESTIBULE is the story of one woman's fight for sexual health, pleasure, and bodily autonomy. Combining verite footage with imaginative dance sequences and intimate voiceover, filmmaker Riley Hooper chronicles her decade-long journey with Vestibulodynia, a vulvovaginal disorder. What feels like a failure of her body becomes an invitation to advocate for herself in a society and medical system that so often dismisses women and people with vulvas. And what begins as a quest for pain-free sex becomes a multigenerational story of resilience, dignity, and self-discovery.

**NEWS**

| | |
|---|---|
| DEC 2025 | Awarded a Rainin Filmmakers with Disabilities Grant from SFFILM, in post-production. SFFILM |
| 2025 | Selected for the Sundance Institute Documentary Edit Residency, following a 2024 Sundance Documentary Film Grant. Sundance Institute |

**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Riley Hooper** Director/Editor
**Caitlin Mae Burke** Producer
**Bryn Silverman** Producer
**Claire Ave'Lallemant** Consulting Editor

| | |
|---|---|
| FORMAT | Feature documentary |
| STATUS | Late production and post-production |
| CONTACT | rileyRhooper@gmail.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ EPs and production company partners
+ Celebrity EPs with interest in the sexual health and pleasure space
+ Brand partnerships with sexual wellness brands
+ Studio or soundstage for a dance shoot (raw space at least 25' x 50' x 14'; NYC, Hudson Valley, or Portland, OR ideal)
+ Camera and G&E gear for the dance shoot
+ Dance studio residency, any location
+ Edit residency, any location
+ Accounting services

**LINKS**

Pitch deck | Sizzle | Donate | Website | Instagram



21 / 23

# walk with me

*A 768-mile protest march ends in a shooting, and competing accounts leave the victim facing charges.*

**SUMMARY**

WALK WITH ME follows a group of Milwaukee activists on a 768-mile march to Washington, D.C. protesting the murder of George Floyd. Along the way, their peaceful march collides with hostility in rural Pennsylvania, culminating in a late-night shooting that injures activist Cino Thurman.

In the aftermath, radically different versions of the event take hold. While the marchers recount chaos and terror, local authorities and community members advance a competing account that leads to the shooter walking free and Cino, the victim, facing criminal charges. The case becomes a flashpoint where opposing realities collide and the limits of justice are exposed.

**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Renée Muza** Director/Producer
**Jeffrey Zimbalist** Producer
**Joseph Jaafari** Field Producer
**Brad Lichtenstein** Advisor
**Carolyn LaVeglia** Post Producer

| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | 80% through principal photography; needs final key interviews, aerial footage, and post-production |
| **CONTACT** | renee@138pictures.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ Legal support and advice specific to Pennsylvania
+ Rights and clearances support
+ Investigative help navigating FOIA requests
+ Production company support
+ Aerial shoots in Milwaukee and Pennsylvania
+ Post-production support
+ Music composition

**LINKS**

Pitch deck

Sizzle on request



22 / 23

# whale like me

*Richard Wright's grandson spends ten years brokering encounters between whales and the people who hunt them.*

**SUMMARY**

WHALE LIKE ME follows Malcolm's improbable 10-year quest to understand whales and broker close encounters between whales and the humans who hunt them, an epic journey that leads him to gain unprecedented access into the guarded world of whaling, while upending his career-oriented life to bring him back to the slave plantation where his grandfather was born.

Malcolm Wright's grandfather was African American activist and author Richard Wright (Native Son, Black Boy, The Outsider, The Man Who Lived Underground). Malcolm is a conservationist, filmmaker and human rights dialogue facilitator.

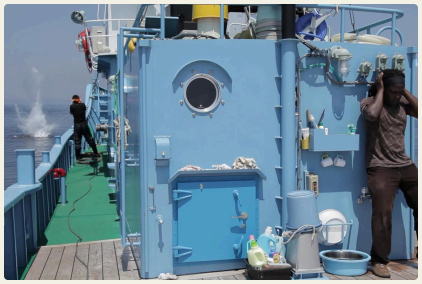
**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Malcolm Wright** Director/Producer/Writer

**Leah Lemieux** Producer

**Bryce Groark** Producer/Cinematographer

**Jennifer Galvin** Producer



| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Feature documentary |
| **STATUS** | Post-production, working toward rough cut |
| **CONTACT** | whalelikeme@quietheartfilm.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ Post-production support (a star editor), including music composition, color, audio, motion graphics, and budget
+ Co-production partners and studios
+ Legal and accounting support
+ Social media strategist
+ Brand partnerships
+ Deck creation
+ Impact producer

**LINKS**

Instagram

Deck and sizzle on request



23 / 23

# when we all get to heaven

*How one of the first gay-positive churches faced the AIDS epidemic, told through 1,200 rescued recordings.*

WINNER, PODCAST & RADIO **Peabody Awards** 2025

WINNER, AUDIO LONG FORM **Wilbur Awards** 2026

EXCELLENCE IN PODCASTS **NLGJA Excellence in Journalism** 2026

FIRST PLACE, IN-DEPTH MULTIMEDIA **AAR Journalism Awards** 2026

LGBTQ+ HISTORY ASSOCIATION **Allan Bérubé Prize**


**SUMMARY**

WHEN WE ALL GET TO HEAVEN is an 11-part audio documentary that tells the story of how one of the first gay-positive churches, the Metropolitan Community Church of San Francisco, faced the personal, social, and political trials of the AIDS epidemic, including the deaths of hundreds of members. The project is based on an archive of 1200 rescued recordings of worship services from the height of the AIDS crisis, 1987-2003. It follows this community as it struggles to make meaning of illness, death, and isolation while caught between two worlds: a religious world saying gays had no place and a gay rights movement saying God had no place.


**NEWS**

**JUN 2026** Won the Excellence in Podcasts Award at the NLGJA Excellence in Journalism Awards. NLGJA

**APR 2026** Won a Peabody Award in the Podcast and Radio category, announced April 23. The series was selected from more than 1,000 entries. Peabody Awards

**APR 2026** The creators and Rev. Jim Mitulski gave Harvard's William Belden Noble Lecture at the Memorial Church. Harvard Gazette

**CREATIVE TEAM**

**Lynne Gerber** Host/EP
**Siri Colom** Co-Creator
**Ariana Nedelman** Co-Creator
**Sayre Quevedo** Story Editor
**Krissy Clark** Managing Producer

| | |
|---|---|
| **FORMAT** | Podcast, 11 parts |
| **STATUS** | Released in 2025 as a ten-part series on Outward, Slate's LGBTQ podcast. Peabody Award winner |
| **CONTACT** | heavenpodcast@gmail.com |

**HOW TO HELP**

+ Promotion and marketing strategy and support
+ Logo design and social media
+ Subscribe to the newsletter at heavenpodcast.org/newsletter
+ Follow on Instagram @eureka.street
+ Contribute at heavenpodcast.org or the crowdfunder

**LINKS**

Trailer | Website | Donate | Crowdfunder | Instagram

# nonfiction hotlist.

This document is meant to be used. These projects are meant to be made.

info@nonfictionhotlist.com